



SCHOOL OF CONSUMER
INTELLIGENCE AND
INFORMATION SYSTEMS



SA ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE UNFILTERED

Policies, Ethics & Innovation
that Actually Works



EXCLUSIVE INVITE ONLY



DATE: 26 May 2026 | **TIME:** 8:30 AM - 12:00 PM

VENUE: STH Kerzner, 57 Bunting Rd, Cottlesloe, Johannesburg, 2092

Executive Roundtable Pre-Reading Pack

SA Artificial Intelligence Unfiltered Roundtable Strategic Readings, Summaries and Further Reading Links

This pre-reading pack was developed to guide participants to policy-relevant literature that can be utilised to shape the AI policy roundtable event held at the University of Johannesburg. The reading material aligns with the six strategic pillars outlined in the previously shared AI policy, as they remain relevant.

Strategic Pillar 1: Capacity and Talent Development

Focus Area: Building national AI capability and workforce readiness.

1. Draft South Africa National AI Policy

Frames the six strategic pillars to inform South Africa's AI policy.

- Access the draft policy [here](#).

2. Presidential Commission on the Fourth Industrial Revolution (PC4IR) Report

Provides South Africa's strategic framework for responding to digital transformation and emerging technologies, with a focus on digital skills, innovation ecosystems, data governance, future work readiness, and infrastructure.

- Access the report [here](#).

3. UNESCO Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence

A global framework on the ethical use of AI.

- Access UNESCO's recommendation [here](#).

4. World Economic Forum – Future of Jobs Report

Details the impact of AI and digital technologies on labour markets and future skills demand.

- Access the report [here](#).



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Strategic Pillar 2: AI for Inclusive Growth and Job Creation

Focus Area: Economic transformation and innovation ecosystems.

1. National Development Plan 2030

Shapes South Africa's long-term developmental priorities.

- Access the plan [here](#).

2. African Union Continental AI Strategy

Positions AI as a catalyst for African development, while emphasising the need for sovereignty and regional cooperation.

- Access the strategy [here](#).

3. McKinsey – The Economic Potential of Generative AI

Provides an examination of the impact of generative AI on industries.

- Access the report [here](#).

Strategic Pillar 3: Responsible Governance

Focus Area: AI governance, cybersecurity and data governance.

1. Protection of Personal Information Act (POPIA)

Regulates the lawful processing of personal information in South Africa.

- Access the Act [here](#).

2. European Union AI Act

Introduces a risk-based framework for AI governance.

- Access the Act [here](#).

3. NIST AI Risk Management Framework

Provides practical guidance on AI-related risk identification, assessment, management, and monitoring.

- Access the Framework [here](#).



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Strategic Pillar 4: Ethical and Inclusive AI

Focus Area: Explainability and bias mitigation.

1. OECD AI Principles

Advocates for trustworthy AI and inclusive growth.

- Access the Principles [here](#).

2. Weapons of Math Destruction – Cathy O’Neil

Explores how opaque algorithms can reinforce systemic injustice.

- Access the book [here](#).

3. Algorithmic Justice League 2026

Highlights racial and gender bias in facial recognition systems and the dangers of insufficiently diverse training datasets.

- Access the website [here](#).

Strategic Pillar 5: Cultural Preservation and International Integration

Focus Area: AI sovereignty, localisation and global cooperation.

1. Smart Africa AI Blueprint

Advocates for collaborative AI development across African states.

- Access the Blueprint [here](#).

2. United Nations Global Digital Compact

Aims to develop shared principles for digital governance and AI cooperation.

- Access the report [here](#).



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Strategic Pillar 6: Human-Centred Deployment

Focus Area: Citizen-centred AI deployment

1. Batho Pele Principles

Promotes people-centred governance and citizen participation.

- Access the Principles [here](#).

2. Stanford Human-Centred AI (HAI)

Promotes research on trustworthy AI, human oversight, governance, and responsible deployment.

- Access the website [here](#).

Articles and Commentaries

Burger-Smidt, A. (2026). *The AI Governance Stack and South Africa's Draft National AI Policy: An Operational Gap in Search of a Framework*. Available:

<https://werksmans.com/the-ai-governance-stack-and-south-africas-draft-national-ai-policy-an-operational-gap-in-search-of-a-framework/>

Damarupurshad, A. (2026). *Critique of South Africa's Draft National AI Policy*. Available:

<https://www.linkedin.com/pulse/critique-south-africas-draft-national-ai-policy-damarupurshad-odinf/>

Fourie, J. (2026). *An AI policy that empowers*. Available:

https://www.ourlongwalk.com/p/an-ai-policy-that-empowers?utm_campaign=post&utm_medium=web.



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Articles and Commentaries

Heeks, R. (2026). *Digital Economy Policy in Developing Countries: What's Needed?*.

Available: https://ict4dblog.wordpress.com/2026/04/30/digital-economy-policy-in-developing-countries-whats-needed/?fbclid=IwY2xjawR34SZleHRuA2FlbQlXMAbicmlkETFMVTBUY0ROcEpSQzlyQTcwc3J0YwZhchBfaWQQMjlyMDM5MTc4ODIwMDg5MgABHroOFR7PMMcJXXUB995DqI467dOO6wE7p8ANbH1iWBDhDGiixDKluUc7vCdx_aem_VukxCU4Qoa6HOR71McMhsA.

Kathure, M. (2024). *Mozilla's Input on South Africa's Draft AI Policy Framework*. Available:

<http://mozillafoundation.org/en/blog/mozillas-input-on-south-africas-draft-ai-policy-framework-advancing-a-trustworthy-inclusive-ai-ecosystem/>.

Kathure, M. (2026). *Comments on the South African Department of Communications and Digital Technologies National AI Policy*. Available:

https://assets.mofoprod.net/network/documents/Mozilla_Comments_South_Africa_National_AI_Policy_Final.pdf.

McCrindle, T. (2026). *AI Policy Debacle Shows Dangers of Technology Used Without Public Oversight: SA's Draft Policy Included Sources Fabricated by a Large Language Model*.

Available: <https://groundup.org.za/article/ai-policy-debacle-shows-dangers-of-technology-used-without-public-oversight/>.

Mokoena, K. (2026). *Draft South Africa National AI Policy published for comment*.

Available: <https://www.michalsons.com/blog/draft-south-africa-national-ai-policy/81592>.

Ngidi, M. & Oliver, D. (2026). *Rebuilding Trust in AI Policymaking: South Africa's Draft AI Policy Withdrawal*. Available: <https://www.adams.africa/darren-olivier/rebuilding-trust-in-ai-policymaking-south-africas-draft-ai-policy-withdrawal/>.



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